Kellen J. Murphy, Ph.D.

Athens, OH 45701 +1 (614) 563-9034 me@kellenmurphy.com
kellenmurphy.com linkedin.com/in/kellenmurphy github.com/kellenmurphy

Profile

Identity Architect and IAM subject matter expert with over a decade of experience designing and operating enterprise-grade identity infrastructure for higher education and beyond. Currently focused on the strategic and technical evolution of identity services at the University of Virginia — from Shibboleth and Grouper operations to privileged access management and OIDC/SAML integrations. Equally comfortable shaping long-term identity strategy and diving deep into complex federation and integration challenges.

Experience

Identity Architect **2022 – Present**
University of Virginia, Identity Services

- Serve as the institutional subject matter expert for all authentication and authorization technologies, advising on SSO integrations, identity strategy, and complex architectural challenges across the university.
- Led the enterprise rollout of Internet2 Grouper, establishing it as the central platform for group and access management across UVA; deployed and operates in a fully containerized Docker Swarm environment.
- Holds significant operational responsibility for UVA's Shibboleth-based (NetBadge) identity provider, ensuring reliability and continuity for the institution's primary IdP.
- Served as senior engineer on the University's Privileged Access Management (PAM) deployment.
- Led the implementation of Keycloak in two distinct capacities: as an OIDC-SAML authentication proxy for high-security network zones, and as a complete guest access solution for the University's Student Information System.
- Play a critical role in shaping and advancing dev/ops practices for the Identity Services team, bridging the gap between infrastructure operations and software development.
- Provide day-to-day guidance on SAML, OIDC, and broader IAM integrations for university stakeholders, from troubleshooting complex federation issues to shaping long-term identity strategy.

Lead IAM Consultant & Software Engineer **2016 – 2022**
IDM Engineering

- Served as lead engineer for all identity projects since 2018, owning the full project lifecycle: scoping, quoting, sales engineering, implementation, documentation, and project management.
- Designed, customized, and implemented SAML-based SSO solutions — including Shibboleth IDP/SP, AD FS, SimpleSAMLphp, WSO2 Identity Server, Keycloak, and OneLogin — tailored to each client's environment and requirements.
- Provided ongoing integration support, day-to-day administration, and managed services for Shibboleth IDP-based SSO environments at multiple R1 and R2 research universities.
- Consistently delivered identity management projects on time and within budget with a strong track record of client satisfaction.

Software Engineer **2016 – 2022**

BCS Engineering (sister company to IDM Engineering)

- Developed custom e-commerce solutions including Xcart and Magento module development, front-end web design, and WordPress plugin development.

Founder **2014 – 2016**
Cardinal Computing Consultants

- Founded and operated an independent consultancy providing data science services to customers nationwide and managed IT support for small businesses in southeast Ohio.

Technical Skills

Single Sign On (SSO) Solutions: Shibboleth (IDP & SP), AD FS, SimpleSAMLphp, WSO2 Identity Server, and Keycloak
IDaaS & Cloud Identity: OneLogin, Okta, Microsoft Entra ID, and PingFederate
Protocols & Standards: SAML 2.0, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, SCIM, LTI, LDAP, PKI, Multilateral Federation
Development: Python (10 years), PHP (7 years), Java (5 years), Groovy (3 years), Perl, C++
Infrastructure & DevOps: RHEL/Linux server administration, Apache, Nginx, Git, Bash, Ansible, SQL, Docker Swarm

Community Involvement

Actively engaged in the higher education Trust & Identity (T&I) community through InCommon and Internet2. Current member of the InCommon Technical Advisory Committee (TAC, term through 2028) and active participant in several working groups: the Software Integration Working Group (SIWG), the Relying Party Onboarding & Discovery Working Group (RPDOWG), and the SIRTFI Exercise Planning Working Group (SEPWG). Presented at the last three Internet2 Technology Exchange conferences, and a two-time presenter and planning committee member for Internet2 BaseCamp.

Communication & Leadership

A distinguishing strength is the ability to pair deep technical expertise with a naturally honed talent for making complex concepts accessible. Whether advising stakeholders on identity architecture, mentoring colleagues on federation standards, or guiding clients through unfamiliar technology, the goal is always the same: leave people more capable and confident than before. This education-first approach, combined with strong organizational skills and a collaborative instinct, makes for an effective partner at every level of an organization.

Certifications

Certified Identity Professional (IDPro) **December 2023**
IDPro credly.com/badges/b6157100-2e86-4bc2-9f02-8e1058d45ef3

Education

Ph.D., Physics (Computational Cosmology) December 2013
Ohio University

M.S., Physics (Theoretical Nuclear Physics) June 2008
Ohio University

B.S., Mathematics & Physics June 2006
Otterbein University